One of the exceptions was the coastal state of Junagadh in Gujarat. It was led by a Muslim Nawab but populated by a Hindu majority. While Junagadh indicated initially that it would accede to India, the acting *dewan* Shah Nawaz Bhutto (father of Pakistan's future prime minister Zulfikar Ali Bhutto), persuaded the leadership to announce an accession to Pakistan on 15 August. Local leaders in several portions of the state disagreed, and Junagadh used its military resources to impose its control over these breakaway regions. Over the following months, both Bhutto in Junagadh and Pakistani leaders in Karachi realized that Pakistan was unable to provide sufficient military assistance, despite prior assurances to the contrary. On 1 November, Indian troops took over some of the disputed territory and, under pressure, the Junagadh State Council reversed its earlier decision on 5 November. [18]

Hyderabad, a much larger and wealthier state in the centre of India, proved a bigger test. Like Junagadh, it was led by a Muslim ruler, the Nizam, but had a mostly Hindu population. With the encouragement of Pakistan's leader Muhammad Ali Jinnah, Hyderabad initially sought independence from both India and Pakistan, including 'full sovereignty and autonomy'. Throughout the subsequent months, negotiations took place over the terms of accession to India, with the Nizam's government seeking greater autonomy. At the same time, the Nizam took steps to secure greater financial independence, enhance arms stockpiles (with the assistance of an enterprising Australian), and further centralize rule. Many of these steps went against the terms of a standstill agreement that had been negotiated with India. Meanwhile, violence by militias, the detention of transiting Indian officials by Hyderabad, and mob attacks on Indian trains added to the tensions. Hyderabad also made an unsuccessful attempt at reaching out to the United Nations. On 13 September 1948, India launched Operation Polo, widely referred to as a 'police action' in Indian officialdom. Five days later, Hyderabadi forces surrendered. [19]

The third territorial crisis of Partition—and one that proved the longest lasting—related to Jammu and Kashmir, a strategically important princely state ruled by a Hindu Maharaja Hari Singh, who governed a majority